

Leadership from Within

Leadership isn't about the captain's armband. Every player can lead at any moment through behaviour, attitude and words. You too.

Group + individual

3 exercises

Evidence-based



What will you take with you today?

01

You recognise **informal leadership** in yourself and others, apart from official roles.

02

You consciously take **at least one leadership moment a week** in training or a match.

03

You actively invest in the **development of a younger** or new teammate.

Cotterill & Fransen (2016) — review: shared leadership (multiple players showing leadership behaviour) correlates more strongly with cohesion and performance than single formal leadership. *Psychology of Sport & Exercise*.

Fransen et al. (2020) — study over 2 seasons with 34 teams: teams with 3+ informal leaders perform significantly more stably than teams with 1 formal leader. *Journal of Sport Sciences*.

Côté & Gilbert (2009) — effective leadership is not position-bound but behaviour-bound; athletes who show 'servant leadership' significantly raise team trust.

1

Who Do I Follow?

Write down two teammates you follow for who they are. What do they concretely do that has influence?

Influence doesn't come from an armband. It comes from behaviour: being on time, supporting others, never giving up.

Broaden the idea of a leader: quiet players who are always there are leaders too. Name this explicitly — not every leader speaks loudly.

LeBron James — 4x NBA Champion, Los Angeles Lakers

Tips for this session



Tip 1 — Quiet leaders

Players who are quiet but always on time and never give up are leaders too. Not every leader speaks loudly.



Tip 2—Join in

The mentor moment works best if you do it too. Pair an experienced with a new player on a shared task.



Tip 3 — Captaincy

Month 7 is the time to discuss captaincy: 'Who shows leadership without the armband?'



Careful: performance only

Don't tie captaincy to performance alone. The best scorer isn't automatically the best leader.

10' Fill in worksheet individually
min

10' min Group discussion: who are the informal leaders?

2' Assign leader of the day
min

3' Explain mentor-moment task
min

MONTH 7 OF 8 · LEADERSHIP FROM WITHIN

Leading from within.

Today you discovered leadership needs no armband — only behaviour that takes others along.

⚡ TEAM RITUAL · THE CIRCLE

● The Circle

Stand together in a circle. Each player says the name of one teammate + one word why they appreciated him/her today. Start yourself as moderator. Name + word — nothing more.

NEXT MONTH → LEGACY & NEXT STEP

Ask players to look back on the whole season. Next month we close: Legacy & Next Step.